

cartridges, called 'game cards'.

The game cards are 33.0 mm × 35.0 mm × 3.8 mm (about half the breadth and depth as Game Boy Advance cartridges) and weigh around 3.5 grams.

The proprietary solid state ROM 'game card' format resembles the memory cards used in other portable electronic devices such as digital cameras. It currently supports cards ranging from 8-256 MB in size.

The cards usually have a small amount of flash memory or an EEPROM to save user data such as game progress or high scores, but there is a small number of games that have no save memory such as *Electroplankton*.

Due to the inclusion of this particular format, the Nintendo DS does not allow for any other type of storage media on the device. Hence, the DS acts as a game console and cannot double up for multimedia purposes. The DSi, however, allows ample multimedia opportunities.

The Nintendo DS is also backwards compatible, and includes another slot for GameBoy Advance cartridges. This slot also doubles up as a port for hardware accessories.

Storage

The DSi was the first model of Nintendo's handheld gaming consoles to come with built-in memory, as the console is equipped with 256 MB of internal flash memory.

The gizmo also allows users to use media functions by loading up their own SD/SDHC cards of up to 32 GB in size in a new card slot behind the cover on the right-side of the handheld.

Connectivity

Connecting to the internet and playing with friends is an integral part of modern gaming, and Nintendo has recognised that in the DS. The console is fitted with a Wi-Fi chip that enables it get to online, or even create a WLAN connection to play with other DS users nearby.

Camera

While the previous models did not come with the ability to click photographs or use video chat, the DSi changed all that with the introduction of two cameras.

The handheld has two VGA (0.3 megapixel) digital cameras; one on the internal hinge pointed towards the user and the other in the outer shell.

Battery

The Nintendo DS contains a rechargeable lithium-ion battery with a capacity of 850 mAh. On a full four-hour charge, the factory 850 mAh battery lasts about 10 hours.

Battery life is affected by multiple factors including speaker volume, use of one or both screens, back lighting, and use of wireless connectivity. The biggest effect